

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

05 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying to register with Ryder Reid Legal as a temporary litigation paralegal candidate. Having completed a year-long placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner and currently advising clients at Citizens Advice, I have hands-on litigation support experience that maps directly onto the roles you place candidates into at leading London firms.

At BCLP, I worked across two litigation-facing teams over twelve months. In international arbitration, I reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and amended sections of the Claimant's memorial. Shortly before a significant submission deadline, I became the only junior supporting the team and took responsibility for coordinating outstanding documents and tracking actions to ensure on-time delivery. In real estate disputes, I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, conducted legal and factual research on landlord and tenant and leasehold issues, managed court filings and maintained matter records in iManage across several matters with competing deadlines. A partner and associate on the arbitration team told me my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor, which I found a meaningful benchmark rather than a routine comment.

At Citizens Advice, I have continued to develop the skills most relevant to temporary litigation support: taking detailed factual statements, identifying evidential gaps, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and managing matters from instruction to submission under real deadline pressure. Working across welfare, housing, employment and debt matters has also meant adapting quickly to unfamiliar legal territory, which matters in temporary placements where there is rarely time for a long run-in.

I am registered to complete the SQE and am building the practical experience to support that. Temporary placements at London litigation practices would let me continue doing substantive work, across different practice environments, while I work toward qualification. Ryder Reid's focus on placing candidates into high-quality interim roles at firms where that experience is genuinely valued is the reason I want to register with you specifically rather than through a general legal recruitment route.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva